



June 2025

[DONATE HERE](#)

— NATIONAL —
GARDENING
— WEEK —



PROCLAMATION



JUNE 1-7, 2025

Members of the Manatee River Garden Club and the Palma Sola Botanical Park Executive Director Beverly Burdette attended the May 28th City of Bradenton City Council meeting to receive the proclamation from Mayor Gene Brown to kick off National Garden Week. Happy Gardening!





2024-2025 VOLUNTEERS OF THE YEAR!

Board of Director of the Year ~ Kristin Mead (left)

Male Volunteer of the Year ~ Bill Steeves

Female Volunteer of the Year ~ Karen Paul

Congratulations to Kristin, Bill, & Karen for the very well-deserved recognition they received at the Garden Party fundraiser for their outstanding dedication to Palma Sola Botanical Park. Their many years of selfless volunteering have not gone unnoticed. They will celebrate with a dinner out at enRich Bistro!



**MASTER
GARDENER**
UF UNIVERSITY of
FLORIDA
IFAS Extension

HORTICULTURAL CLASSES

The University of Florida/IFAS Manatee County Extension have partnered with us to offer horticultural classes at Palma Sola Botanical Park. Sign up online through EventBrite (links below), stop by the park, or call 941-761-2866 to reserve your spot.



Florida-Friendly Landscaping™

The Value of Trees

11am-12:30pm Thursday June 19th

Palma Sola Botanical Park (Indoors)

9800 17th Ave. NW Bradenton

Trees contribute much more to humans than most people may think. Please join us to learn all of the many benefits that trees give us that we may not even realize. Perhaps you'll be introduced to some trees you've never heard of, that are now appropriate to grow in our zone!

Click here to sign up:

[Florida-Friendly Landscaping™ The Value of Trees Tickets, Thu, Jun 19, 2025 at 11:00 AM | Eventbrite](#)

ART
ART
IN THE

PARK

Cynthia Maniglia, our June featured Artist of the Month, works



in acrylic, oil, pastels, Chinese ink, digital art, and mixed media. Art is in her blood; Cynthia's father was a commercial artist who encouraged her to draw and paint from a young child. Native Florida plants and landscapes are some of her favorite subjects to draw and paint. A member of The Parrish Arts Council for several years, she also taught watercolor painting classes at the Lakewood Ranch YMCA. In the past, she created handmade cards with dried botanical elements that were sold on Rodeo Drive in California and in high-end gift shops nationwide. Follow her on Instagram & Facebook at 'sandsaltmoon'.



You're invited...

Art Exhibition/Meet the Artist Night

4-6pm Wednesday June 24, 2025

Palma Sola Botanical Park ~ 9800 17TH Ave. NW Bradenton

Free. Public welcome. All art is for sale & helps support the park!





FIELD TRIP!

Our first school field trip with Stewart Elementary's entire kindergarten went off without a

hitch. The students went on a scavenger hunt with binoculars throughout the entire park.

explored our butterfly garden and planted a butterfly plant to take home, played fun field games, then had a picnic lunch in our covered pavilion. Thank you to Ms. Downs, Mrs. Bates, Mrs. Powell, our volunteers, and many parent chaperones that helped. We hope we inspired a bunch of future gardeners! 🌱



HIGH SCHOOL STUDENTS!

Need Bright Futures Hours?

9am-Noon Wednesdays June 4th – August 6th, 2025
Palma Sola Botanical Park ~ 9800 17th Ave. NW Bradenton

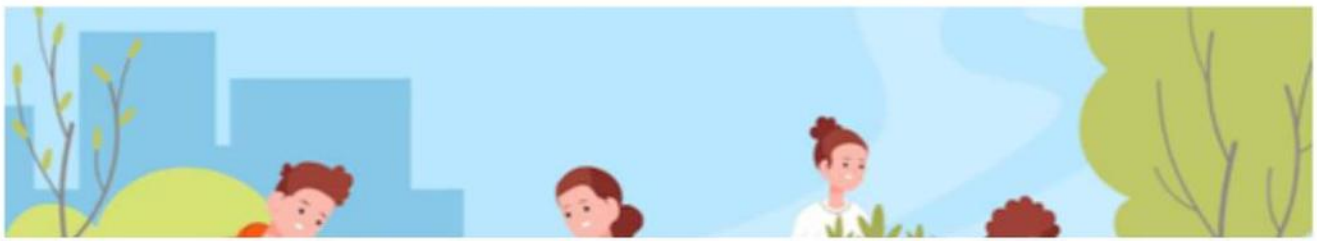
The non-profit 501(c)(3) Palma Sola Botanical Park is in search of high school volunteers (rising Freshman and up) to come help us with planting, weeding, propagating, mulching, office work, etc. to earn Bright Futures community service hours for college. No experience is needed, we provide & fill out your Bright Futures paperwork, provide snacks & cold water, and make it fun! Call us at 941-761-2866 with any questions or just show up Wednesdays! www.palmasolabp.org





DOWNTOWN BRADENTON PUBLIC MARKET

Bev Burdette (left) and Jenny Gunter recently participated as the featured Non-Profit booth at the Downtown Bradenton Public Market (aka. the Farmer's Market on Old Main St.) to promote outreach for the park. Palma Sola Botanical Park plans to participate next season (Oct. 2025 - May 2026) for a few Saturdays and would love to have enthusiastic volunteers from the park spend a fun Saturday helping to spread the word to the community about our beautiful gardens. Please reach out to Bev or Jenny, if you are interested.



JULY GARDENING WORKDAY!

8:30am-12pm Tues. July 15th

Palma Sola Botanical Park

9800 17th Ave. NW Bradenton

Whole Foods employees are coming to help!

**Bring your pruners. All Welcome. No experience necessary.
We'll supply the other tools, water, Gatorade, & snacks.**

"Many hands make light work."

Join in July when we welcome employees from Whole Foods that have partnered with us to help give back to their community! No RSVP needed... just come on out if you are

feeling it to get some fresh air, exercise, and meet other plant lovers!



AED AT THE PARK

Thank you, Ernie Withers and the Defibrillate Manatee Foundation, for the wonderful donation of an Automated External Defibrillator (AED) that was recently installed in our Galleria building. He even provided complimentary CPR/AED/Choking course for staff and key volunteers. Ernie's story is inspiring ~ he started the non-profit Defibrillate Manatee Foundation after he went into

cardiac arrest and was saved by an AED at a Pirates game in 2023. We hope that we will never need it, but if we do, we'll be ready!



LEAF SCULPTURE

Thank you to Suzy & Kevin Spence with My Legacy Leaves for the gorgeous philodendron leaf sculpture donation that they installed in front of our Galleria. The photo does not do it justice. It shines like a metallic rainbow in the sunlight! Check out their website at <https://mylegacyleaves.com/>.



HURRICANE RELIEF UPDATE

A huge thank you to Mike DeChelbor (red hat) for offering his services "dirt cheap" to grind and remove many of the enormous stumps remaining from the large specimen trees that were blown over by Hurricane Milton's winds. Ken Brickse (grey hat) was instrumental in coordinating the endeavor and lent a hand. We are so appreciative of the community's support as we continue to rebuild. We have made great strides but still have a long way to go. Please consider donating to our hurricane relief fund to help us continue to heal.

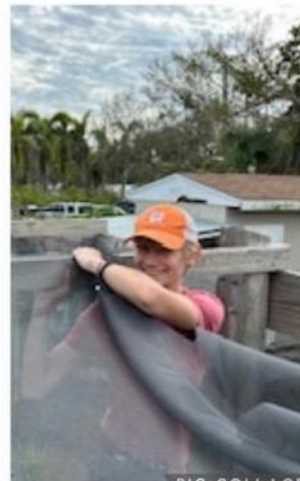
[DONATE TO HURRICANE RELIEF HERE](#)



BOY SCOUTS
OF AMERICA®

SCOUT UPDATE

Thank you to Zoran Zejavac for repairing our greenhouse in the Hidden Garden Nursery as his Eagle Scout project. Zoran and the troop replaced the shade cloth that was destroyed by Hurricane Milton. We are very appreciative of local Boy Scout Troop 22 that meets at Palma Sola Presbyterian Church. These fantastic young men have recently completed several projects here at the park ~ a bat house, a bee hotel, a free little library, and the greenhouse. We know you will do great things in life!



PIC•COLLAGE

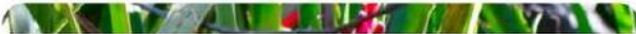
Do you know a Boy or Girl Scout looking for an Eagle Scout or Gold Award Project idea? We welcome Scouts as they are known for their stewardship to the outdoors and would be glad to work with them. Contact Beverly in the office for project ideas!

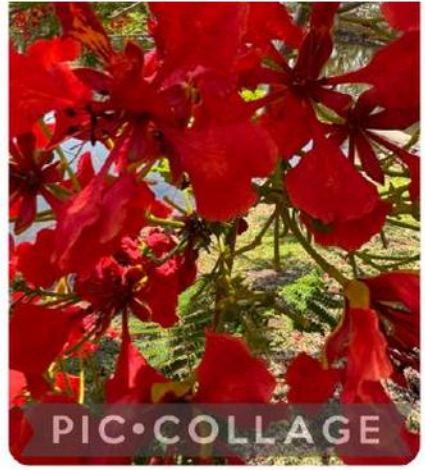


CHRISTINE LEAMON
~June~

Christy, a retired school principal, is living her best life enjoying nature! She is an avid birder, a gardener, and nature photographer. She recently began volunteering at the park and has already helped in so many ways including on our Events Committee planning fundraisers, mentoring the Bright Futures high school volunteers, teaching the school field trip children about plants and butterflies, helping restore the gardens after the hurricanes, and so much more. Everything she does, she does it well, with such an easy, relaxing demeanor. With her experience and many skillsets, she is such a blessing to have around. We are so lucky that you chose us to volunteer your free time with us and we truly appreciate you!

"Many hands make light work."





FLORA ~ WHAT'S BLOOMING?

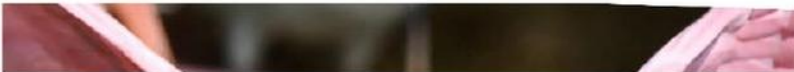
The amateur images courtesy of Bev Burdette's iPhone.

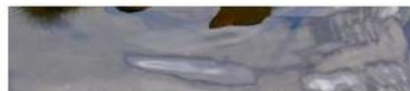




FAUNA ~ RECENTLY SPOTTED!

These amazing images are courtesy of wildlife photographer Helen Lewis.





FEATHERED FRIENDS ~ RECENTLY SPOTTED!
These amazing images are courtesy of wildlife photographer Helen Lewis.



POP-UP

MUSICAL MOTION

FREE class for children and parents!

What's this program about?

Who can participate?



Musical Motion is a fun parent-child learn & play class that encourages bonding while developing early learning and literacy skills in children. Sessions focus on creative activities that enhance brain development and build preschoolers' social skills, language skills, motor skills, and more.

How will it benefit my family?

Musical Motion helps children gain crucial skills that prepare them for school success. You will also learn effective activities that you can do at home to help your child thrive. Parents enjoy playing with their children and socializing with other parents and children. You will also have access to Parenting Educators to answer questions about parenting and your child's development.

Thursday
June 26, 2025
12:30 – 1:30 pm

Thursday
July 24, 2025
12:30 – 1:30 pm

Palma Sola Botanical Park

9800 17th Ave NW, Bradenton, FL 34209

Check out our **other Pop-Up Classes** on our **Website** and **Facebook** page!

Musical Motion is for parents/caregivers and their children, ages 0-5. Our educators are experts at engaging all kids in their own way, in their own time.

If you like this pop-up class, you can join us during the summer at the following locations:



Summer 2025 Schedule

June 2 – July 31

Monday

12:30-1:30 pm
[Central Library](#)
1301 1st Ave W
Bradenton

Tuesday

10:00-11:00 am
[Forza](#)
7006 122nd Ave E
Parrish

Wednesday

10:00-11:00 am
[Mothers Helping Mothers](#)
5933 N Washington Blvd
Sarasota

Thursday

10:00-11:00 am
[South Manatee Branch Library](#)
6081 26th St W
Bradenton

Friday

1:00 pm-2:00 pm
[Palmetto Library](#)
923 6th St W
Palmetto
(No class at this location July 4th)



PARENTING MATTERS

For more information: ParentingMattersfl.org | Phone: (941) 756-3007 | Programs@ParentingMattersfl.org





Nursery

OPEN
TUESDAYS
9am-Noon
Volunteer Nursery

**100% of Proceeds Benefit
Palma Sola Botanical Park**

YOGA
in the
PARK

Enjoy yoga here at the park in our beautiful, relaxing setting. Plus, a portion of the proceeds support the Park! Please contact the instructors directly with any questions, prices, and to reserve your spot.

MONDAYS 4-5pm

Basic Hatha Yoga/Alignment/All Levels with *Angela Simone*

Basic Hatha Yoga/Alignment/All Levels with *Angela Simone*

Call 941-704-8953 or walk-ins welcome.

TUESDAYS 6-7pm

Yoga/Pilates/Weights with *Laura Bennett*

Call 941-758-1741 to reserve your spot.

WEDNESDAYS 9-10am

Basic Hatha Yoga/Alignment/All Levels with *Angela Simone*

Call 941-704-8953 or walk-ins welcome.

HORTICULTURE MAGAZINE ARTICLE

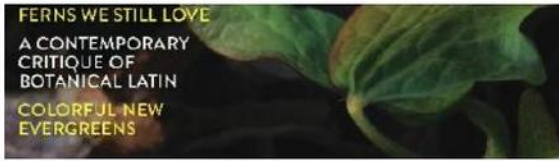


NOTES FROM THE GARDEN

ON THE TRAIL OF TROPICAL FRUIT

Exploring the Manatee Rare Fruit Council's collection at Palma Sola Botanical Park





Above: Palma Sola Botanical Park, near Bradenton, Fla., showcases collections of various palms as well as fruiting and flowering trees. Its walking paths take visitors on an exploration of the plants that ring serene water features.

Palma Sola Botanical Park was recently featured in the Nov/Dec issue of the national Horticulture magazine. It is a fantastic article by Greg Coppa highlighting the Manatee Rare Fruit Council's tropical fruit trees with breathtaking photos. Click on the link below to read the entire article.

[READ HORTICULTURE MAGAZINE ARTICLE HERE](#)



Please consider supporting the park by becoming a member or renewing your membership. An annual gift of membership supports the ongoing sustainability and enhancement of the gardens. There are several levels for all budgets that come with perks including reciprocal membership to botanical parks across the country.

Memberships begin anytime and are valid for 1 year from the start date.

[Members – Palma Sola Botanical Park](#)



AMERICAN HORTICULTURAL SOCIETY



**RECIPROCAL
GARDEN NETWORK**

member garden

[Reciprocal Admissions Program – American Horticultural Society \(ahsgardening.org\)](https://www.ahsgardening.org/)

BECOME A MEMBER HERE



OUR STORY

In 1990, the grassroots initiative for a botanical park began when local citizens and community groups rallied to save the 10 acre site from development that had previously served as the Manatee County Nursery. In 1993, the non-profit 501(c)(3) Palma Sola Botanical Park Foundation, Inc. was established and the park has evolved ever since. The park does not charge an entrance fee and receives no federal, state, or local government subsidies. We rely greatly on donations to keep the park open free of charge to the public 7 days per week.

HOURS

Park Hours:

8am~Dusk Every Day

Office Hours:

8am~5pm Mon.-Fri.

ALWAYS FREE ADMISSION!

STAFF

Beverly Z. Burdette, Executive Director

Jennifer Gunter, Office Manager/Venue Rentals

Ken Brickse, Maintenance

BOARD OF DIRECTORS

Kristin Mead, President

Tyler Pullen, Vice President

Michael Jaster, Treasurer

Aedan Stockdale, Secretary

Josh Beyer

Barney Hass

John Lowenberg

Tyler Pullen

Nick Baden, Emeritus

Beverly Burdette, Ex-Officio

CONTACT INFORMATION

Palma Sola Botanical Park Foundation, Inc.

Park Address:

9800 17th Avenue Northwest

Bradenton, Florida 34209

Mailing Address:

P.O. Box 14214

Bradenton, Florida 34280

(941) 761-2866

palmasolabp@aol.com



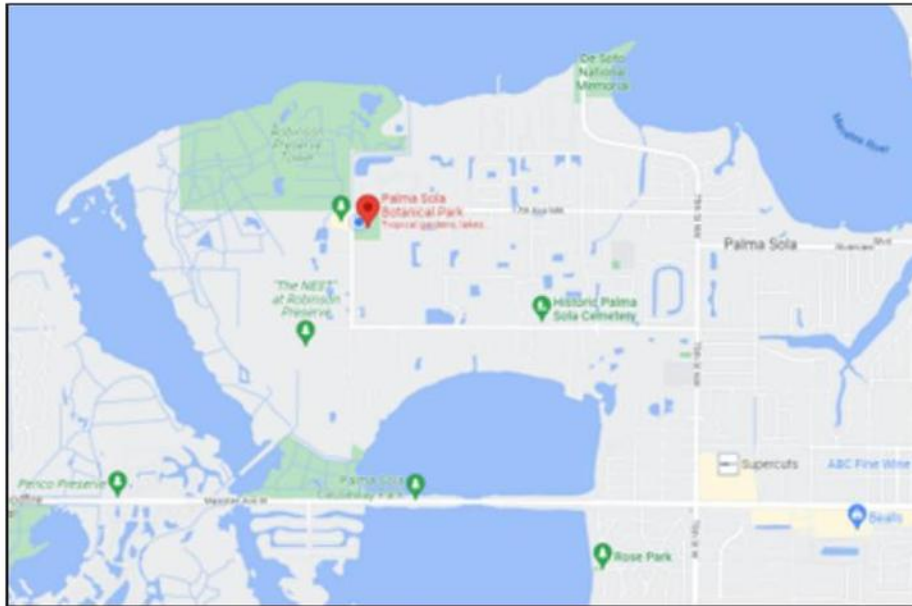
Our mission is to serve as a unique community resource dedicated to providing an interactive learning environment that fosters an appreciation of nature and landscaping, preserves our natural resources and promotes environmental education.

The Palma Sola Botanical Park Foundation, Inc. is a 501(c)(3) non-profit organization. Contributions are normally tax deductible under current IRS codes.

DONATE HERE

Manatee Rare Fruit Council





It takes a village... thank you for helping our garden grow!

Garden Party!

Evening Under the Stars

TO BENEFIT THE PALMA SOLA BOTANICAL PARK

Event Sponsors

Royal Poinciana Level



Silk Floss Level



Southern Magnolia Level



Royal Palm Level



Nancy Reed



Thank you for your generosity & continued support!



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